

hour of raw video will occupy about 6 GB of disk space, so be prepared to have to upgrade that 40 GB hard drive if you want to get into video editing. We recommend at least a 200 GB, 7200 rpm SATA (I or II) hard drive if you plan on editing and capturing over two or three hours of video. Of course, that's just disk space, and you have a decent PC configuration as well. Any of the latest CPUs and motherboards will do (a Pentium 4 @3 GHz or AMD Athlon 64 3000+, or better), and at least 512 MB of DDR RAM—we'd still recommend 1 GB of RAM! A DirectX 9 compatible graphics card with 64 MB of video memory is also recommended.

This doesn't mean that people with lower configurations cannot edit videos, it just means that you will need some coffee, snacks and a TV guide handy if you want to try and edit video with anything lower.

6.2 Non-Linear Editing

The definition of Non-Linear Editing (NLE) is exactly what we consider “editing” to be. It is the process or task of taking a video or audio clip (or multiple clips) and splitting and joining various parts together to improve on the original. You can add effects and change the way the clip starts, how it ends, put the ending in the middle, put the start of the clip at the end, etc.

There are other older methods of editing, such as linear editing, which is editing a clip, but not changing timelines or the order of the frames. All the editing you will ever do will be of the NLE type though, so let's just stick with that.

In order to do non-linear editing, you will need to have the video clips on your computer, which we've already spoken about in the previous section. From here on, we will consider that you have the required videos on your hard drive, and walk you through how you can go about editing them.